

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

How to Talk to AI — Worst-Genie improv tips, sample repairs, scoring guidance, and the AI-honesty discussion.



WHY THIS LESSON

Every AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**: a person starts it (the prompt) and a person ends it (the check). Those two human jobs are the whole skill, and they transfer to every AI tool your students will ever touch. This lesson trains both: P.R.O. is the start; the trickster-genie habit is the end.

PLAYING THE WORST GENIE EVER

Three moves cover every wish: **take a word literally** ("rich" = a name), **fill the missing detail badly** (money = play money), or **grant it in the least useful form** (a story = one word: "Hero."). Stay cheerful — the genie is never mean, just maddeningly literal. The gold moment is when a student adds fine print and you have to grant it properly: applaud it.

SAMPLE GENIE-PROOF REPAIRS

There is no single right answer — score with the Genie-Proof Checklist. Exemplars:

CURSED	EXEMPLAR REPAIR
Amara — "tell me about space"	"I'm a 7th grader making a one-page science poster about black holes, due Friday. Give me 5 amazing facts, each under 20 words, written so a 5th grader could get it. No math formulas."
Mateo — "help me save money"	"I'm 12 and get \$15 a week. I want \$120 headphones in 10 weeks. Make a simple weekly savings plan as a table, and give 2 tips for not spending it on snacks."
Yuki — "make a story about a hero"	"Write the opening paragraph (max 100 words) of an anime-style story about a shy kid whose sketchbook drawings come to life. Mysterious tone, end on a cliffhanger."

SCORING GUIDANCE

- **Proficient:** all three P.R.O. clauses present and specific; partner-genie couldn't twist it.
- **Developing:** two clauses, or vague ones ("make it short").
- **Beginning:** restated the cursed wish with more words.

✦ THE AI-HONESTY DISCUSSION (USE ANYTIME IT COMES UP)

Q: "Is using AI cheating?" — One sentence settles it: *AI is your editor, not your ghostwriter*. Feedback, brainstorming, checking understanding = editor. Handing in its work with your name on it = ghostwriter, and a wish you never earned. Ask: "What did YOU make?"

Q: "Is the AI always right?" — No. It predicts likely words; it can be confidently wrong ("hallucinate") — a trickster genie. Rule of thumb: anything that's a checkable fact (dates, numbers, names, quotes) gets checked against a real source before you use it.

Q: "Will AI take all the jobs?" — The honest answer: it changes jobs. The people who win are the ones who can direct it well — which is exactly the skill in today's lesson.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: P.R.O. instruction. Assessed: Genie-Proof Checklist P/R/O rows.*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: the AI-Honesty discussion ("Is the AI always right?", p.2) and the scripted trickster rule that opens the Exit Ticket block. Assessed: Exit Ticket #2.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1-3 above.) *Taught: all three clauses. Assessed: wish repairs + Exit Ticket #1.*

SUPPORT: P.R.O. SENTENCE STARTERS

P: "I am a ____ grader working on _____. I want ____ for _____."

R: "Keep it ____ (length). Use a ____ tone. Include _____. Do NOT _____."

O: "Give me the answer as a ____ (list / table / paragraph / steps)."

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